

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

1 · Framework		Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map	
Method	Uses	Region	Organ
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)	L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)	Forehead	Heart
Inquiry	Verbal questioning	Nose	Spleen
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse	R cheek (patient's)	Lung
		Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.

2 · Shen (Vitality)			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady

Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.

Deranged Shen (shén luàn)

Deranged Shen	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC
Bái hé bīng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking
Diǎn (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

3 · Five Colors of Face		5 · Eyes: Five Wheels		
Color	Indication	Wheel	Structure	Organ
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)	Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)	Qi	Sclera	Lung
		Wind	Iris	Liver
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)	Water	Pupil	Kidney
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion	Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/Stomach
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis	Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.		

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.		Eye Color	
Color	Pattern	Color	Pattern
Secretions: Color Rule	FindingMeaning	Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant
		Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant
		Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp
		Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level
		Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)
4 · Appearance, Body Shape & Movement	Body Shape	Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)
		Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire
		Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung
		Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat
4 · Appearance, Body Shape & Movement	FindingPattern	ColorPattern	Pattern

Movement & Posture

Finding	Pattern
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang
Slow movement + cold	Deficiency Yin
Finding	Pattern
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)
Paralysis	Internal wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

Eye Color (cont.)		Eye Shape/Move (cont.)	
Color	Pattern	Presentation	Pattern
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)	Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency	Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat	Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm	Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, thready pulse	Blood deficiency
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency	Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.		Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels
Eye Shape & Movement		6 • Nose	
Presentation	Pattern	Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).	
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp	Finding	Pattern
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess	Green/blue tip	Cold
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency	Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency	White tip	Blood deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)	Red tip	Heat
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)	Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency	Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels	Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
		Red bridge	Liver fire
		Finding	Pattern
		Dry and black	Toxic heat
		Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
		Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
		Swollen nose	Excess condition
		Sunken nose	Deficiency condition
		Nasal polyps	Stagnated heat in Yangming channel
		Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny.	
		Edema Starts In	Organ
		Upper body/head	Lung
		Lower body/feet	Kidney
		4 limbs/torso	Spleen
7 • Ears		8 • Teeth	
Kidney opens to ear.		Kidney — teeth are the "surplus of bone."	

Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Swelling/pain, middle ear	Heat in the Shaoyang	White, moist, bright/clean	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry/withered/black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence exhausted	Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Purulent discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat Liver/GB	Yellowing, gradual w/ age	Normal aging
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency	Sudden dull yellow (soybean)	Kidney deficiency
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution	Gray and black (black bean)	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Small earlobes	Poor constitution	Dry, black, gray	Kidney Yin deficiency
Shiny, moist earlobes	Good prognosis	Tartar, grimy yellow	Stomach turbidity
Dry, withered earlobes	Poor prognosis / Kidney Qi exhaustion	Burnt and dry	Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Yellow/white pus discharge	Kidney Yin def. w/ fire, or Liver/GB damp-heat	Delayed baby/adult teeth	Essence and Jing deficiency
Ear color: white	Sudden wind-cold invasion	Deviated growth / missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Ear color: green/black	Pain	Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums	Fire flaring up from Kidney Yin def.
Ear color: black	Kidney failure		
Ear color: red	Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)		
Ear color: yellow	Damp accumulation		
Tinnitus	Organ		
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver		
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney		

Gums (Spleen/Stomach)		Throat & Tonsils (Stomach+Lung)	
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Moist, deep red (normal)	Normal	Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Deep red + swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire	Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Pale	Blood deficiency	Acute pain+redness+swelling	Wind invasion (exterior)
Atrophied	Kidney deficiency	Chronic redness/swelling	Interior Stomach heat
Blue line between teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning	Chronic sore/dry, NOT swollen/red	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat
Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding	Stomach fire pushing blood out	Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red	Heat in Stomach/Intestines
		Chronic erosion, comes and goes	Empty (deficiency) heat
		Chronic erosion, hard raised ulcers	Blood stasis with phlegm-heat
Lips & Mouth (Spleen)		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency	Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, Qi deficiency bg.
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation	Chronically red/swollen tonsils	Heat or toxic heat, Stomach/LI
Bright red lips	Heat toxins	Acutely red/swollen tonsils	Wind-heat invasion w/ toxicity
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat	Acute red/swollen with exudate	Heat toxins, Stomach/LI (vs. cold)
Dry, red lips	Heat damaging fluids		
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain)		
Deviated mouth	Wind		
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern		
Finding	Pattern		
Mouth remains open + fever/thirst/canker sores	Excess heat		
Breathing through open mouth	Empty/deficiency pattern		
Open mouth + SOB + frothy sputum	Lung deficiency w/ phlegm stagnation		
Sudden attack, drooling, LOC	Wind		

9 • Hair		Skin	
Blood + Kidney Essence. Women ruled by Blood, men by Qi.		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Lustrous, harmonious (normal)	Normal
Original color, shiny, lustrous, moist	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence	Red	Heat
Premature graying	Depletion of Kidney essence	Yellow, orangish	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
Dull, brittle, easily broken	Kidney essence or Liver Blood def.	Yellow, dusky	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
Thick, lustrous	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence	Too moist	Lung not controlling fluids
Thin, sparse	Deficiency of Kidney	Dry	Blood/fluid deficiency
Thinning/falling out, general	Blood deficiency	Dark, with scales	Blood stasis
Falling out in patches	Blood deficiency within channels	Itching	Wind
Nails		Finding	Pattern
Reflect the Liver.		Pitting edema (upper→down)	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.
		Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness
		Edema from feet up, worse below	Yin edema

Finding	Pattern	Skin Lesions
Pink, normal luster	Sufficient Qi	
Dark red	Heat	Lesion
Pale	Blood deficiency or cold	Description
Blanch returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood	Papule
Blanch returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood	Macule
Withered, dried	Liver/Kidney Yin insufficiency; chronic Bi	Blister
Atrophied / peeled	Yin deficiency	Nodule
Soft and thin	Deficiency of Blood	
Finding	Pattern	Term
Rough, thick, dull, no transparency	Qi/Blood deficiency with wind	Yong — Yang carbuncle
Longitudinal striping	Liver Blood def., trauma, fungal infection	Ju — Yin carbuncle
Brittle	Blood deficiency, wind, or trauma	Ding — boil/furuncle
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation, wind-Bi	Jie — furuncle
Spoon-shaped	Qi/Blood stag., malnutrition, Spleen def.	
Ridged	Kidney Yin def., Liver Yang rising, Blood def.	
Bluish thenar veins	Cold in the Stomach	
Short bluish thenar veins	Empty (deficiency) pattern	
Finding	Pattern	
Red thenar veins	Heat	
Purple thenar veins	Blood stasis	

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic

Applies to nasal discharge, sputum, stool, vaginal discharge alike.

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis

Gate Reached	Severity	Vein Color	Indication
Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.		Light red, not very visible	Normal
Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen	Bright red	Heat
Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness	Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Life Gate	Severe illness	Green or dark blue	Wind
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening		

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged)

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao’s recorded lecture says **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested. Prof. Schrier’s own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz.

Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)

Marker	Weak	Strong
Eyes/nose/ears/mouth	Close together	Well-proportioned
Space between eyebrows	Small	Broad forehead/forehead
Nose	Narrow, flared	Straight, well-formed
Philtrum	Short	Long
Cheeks	Thin	Full, normal luster
Jaw	Flat, sunken, narrow	Strong, even, smooth
Ears	Small, short lobes	Long, long lobes
Muscles/skin	Flabby, loose	Firm

Cause of Weak Constitution
Parents’ general health
Health at time of conception
Mother’s health during pregnancy
Parental age/pregnancy events (stress, trauma, drugs/alcohol/smoking)

Heads Up — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis; Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, herbs, acupuncture, yang sheng) can improve it.

Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64)		
Element	Physical	Personality
Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious
Earth	Yellow complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen	Dignified, calm, unassertive, likes helping people
Metal	Pale complexion, square face, flat abdomen, strong voice	Honest, upright, rational, leadership aptitude
Water	Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round body, swaying gait	Laid-back, unafraid, tendency to deceive, always moving
Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.		